

LDT4SSC Project Methodology

Step 2: Specifications (VALIDATE)

Data Governance Workshop

**Workshop: Mapping
Stakeholders' Legitimacy and
Authority to Act in Data
Governance: Understand Roles,
Responsibilities, and
Hierarchical Influence**

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Document History

Date	Version	Edited by	Description
May 2026	v1	Marine Le Gall, Laura Riou, Sophie Houzet	First version adapted from the CAPACities program.

Workshop Overview

Title	Mapping Stakeholders' Legitimacy and Authority to Act in Data Governance: Understand Roles, Responsibilities, and Hierarchical Influence
Methodological step	Step 2: VALIDATE (Specifications)
Duration	1 hour and 30 mins
Number of Facilitators	1 for each group of 4 to 5 people
Equipment Needed	• One big sheet of paper (1m/2m) or a large (digital) whiteboard • Sticky notes • Pens and markers
Expected outputs	• Data-related stakeholder map with legitimacy to act and hierarchical status • List of key data governance participants. • Preliminary assignment for data-governance roles • A summary note produced after the workshop, outlining key findings and next steps

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1. Context and objectives

The **Mapping Stakeholders' Legitimacy and Authority to Act in Data Governance** workshop is part of the **VALIDATE step (specification)** which bridges the gap between the project's initial idea and its practical implementation. It translates the use cases into **technical and functional requirements**, while accounting for real-world constraints such as interoperability, data, architecture, security, and putting the user's needs at the center.

More information on the objectives, prerequisites and stakeholders to involve in the EXPLORE step can be found on the LDT4SSC Knowledge Hub¹.

The workshop is designed to achieve the following objectives:

- Identify and **map stakeholders' roles, responsibilities, and influence** in data governance.
- Clarify **formal and informal authority** to ensure inclusive decision-making.
- **Raise awareness** of differences in legitimacy and authority among **individuals working with data**.
- **Map hierarchical positions** to facilitate the creation of a dedicated data governance unit and assign responsibilities.

2. Workshop

2.1. Workshop phases overview

<i>Time spent</i>	<i>Phase</i>	<i>Description</i>
15 mins	0. Framing and Icebreaker	Participants revisit the selected use case and project objectives to keep discussions grounded.
30 mins	1. Mapping Contributors	Participants identify and describe the different roles involved in the data lifecycle and data governance
15 mins	2. Assigning Hats	Participants assign "hats" to individuals based on their hierarchical position to illustrate degree of decision-making authority
30 mins	3. Synthesising Insights and Assigning Governance Roles	The group summarises the workshops' key findings, hence guiding the future development of data-governance and identifying the several individuals requiring formal mission statements.

2.2. Detailed Workshop schedule

Phase 0: Framing and Icebreaker (recommended allocated time: 15 mins)

The facilitator orients the participants **towards the selected use case** and the overarching project objectives. They list all **relevant project factors** such as: goals, stakeholders, budget. This initial phase ensures that the subsequent discussions remain grounded in a **clear and concrete context**. It also serves to **align all stakeholders** on the purpose, scope,

¹ https://knowledgehub.ldt4ssc.eu/resources_content/methodology/

and expected outcomes of the workshop, fostering a shared understanding before diving into deeper phases.

The facilitator also **organises an icebreaker** designed to foster mental and creative engagement by encouraging participants to adopt a playful, and open mindset. This initial interactive, game-like activity, stimulates imaginative thinking, reduces initial social tension, and prepares participants to engage fully in subsequent workshop phases.

Phase 1: Mapping Contributors (recommended allocated time: 30 mins)

In this phase, participants will **identify all individuals involved in the data lifecycle and data-governance**. Participants use a large sheet of paper with a central circle, positioning data related roles around it. The facilitator guides the process, ensuring all relevant roles—especially across different business lines and use case domains—are included.

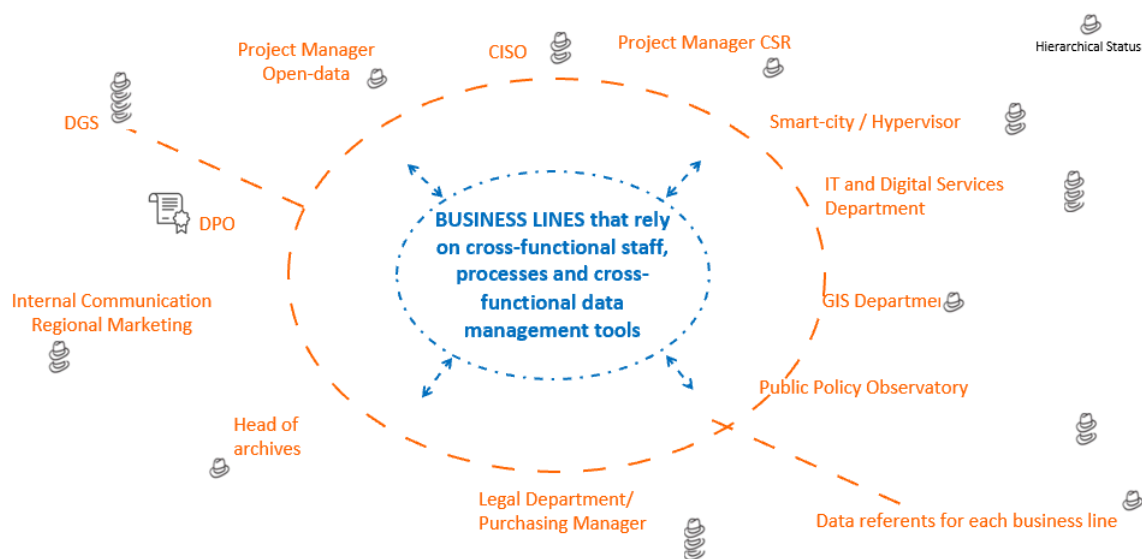


Figure 1. Overview of the business lines to include in internal data governance

Each role is further described with the associated skills required, name of the person in the position and involvement in the LDT project and consortium or any other relevant information.

Figure 1 is intended as an illustrative example rather than a representation of a specific organizational structure. It illustrates the organizational environment used as a reference framework for the workshop. At the center, a blue circle represents the organisation's business lines /domains that have direct access to cross-functional staff and tools. Around this core, a dashed orange circle delineates the cross-domain roles. Above the orange boundary, several job titles are presented as examples of data-related cross-functional staff. The hats displayed next to each role indicate the relative hierarchical level and degree of decision-making authority associated with the position (phase 2 of the workshop).

For projects involving a **federation of Local Digital Twins**, this exercise should be conducted for each public authority in the consortium, with the resulting governance overviews later linked to illustrate the broader collaboration, as depicted in *Figure 2*.

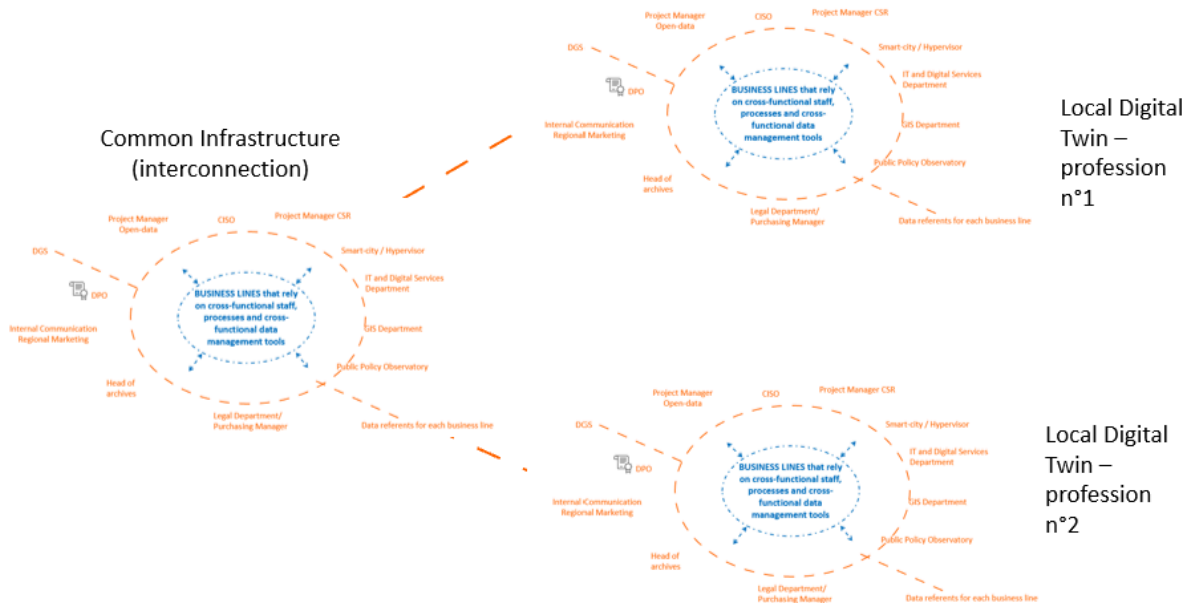


Figure 2. Data governance in LDT federations.

Visual mapping is used as it usually helps participants understand who is involved and where legitimacy gaps may exist.

Phase 2: Assigning Hats (recommended allocated time: 15 mins)

This phase focuses on **visualising hierarchical authority and legitimacy** within the identified roles. Participants assign symbolic "hats" to individuals, with the number of hats reflecting their level of authority—the higher their position, the more hats they receive.

The facilitator clarifies the significance of this exercise, encouraging discussion about influence and decision-making power, while identifying potential obstacles to effective governance, and supporting prioritization of stakeholders for governance responsibilities.

Phase 3: Synthesising Insights and Assigning Governance Roles (recommended allocated time: 30 mins)

The group consolidates the information gathered, documenting each contributor's name, role, and number of hats. The facilitator ensures the documentation is complete, prompts reflection on any gaps or missing roles, and summarises the insights to inform the development of **data governance**.

This phase provides a clear, actionable reference for assigning responsibilities and shaping the governance structure moving forward. It will also **provide a practical reference for identifying a project level data-governance committee** and the **several individuals requiring formal mission statements** to take part in the data-governance.

2.3. Recommendations for Workshop facilitation

To ensure the workshop's effectiveness, facilitators are advised to adopt the following approaches:

Prepare the Circle Diagram for Clarity and Engagement

To ensure a productive session, the circle diagram should be **pre-drawn on a large sheet of paper or in a digital format**, positioned where all participants can **clearly see and engage with it**.

Include All Contributors

It is essential to **include every contributor** to the data governance, management and lifecycle, even those who may appear peripheral. Their roles, though less visible, might still be **critical to the overall governance structure**. By acknowledging all stakeholders, the workshop ensures that the **final map reflects the full complexity** of data governance within the organisation.

Encourage Reflection on Formal and Informal Roles

Facilitators should prompt participants to **consider both formal and informal roles** within the data governance, management and lifecycle as this broader perspective fosters a **more comprehensive understanding** of how contributions are made across the organisation. Recognising informal influences ensures that **all dynamics** —even those not immediately obvious or official— are captured in the mapping.

Facilitate Open Dialogue on Legitimacy and Influence

The discussion should be guided in a manner that encourages an **open and non-judgmental exploration** of legitimacy and influence. Participants must feel **free to examine the nuances of authority and decision-making**, as this transparency reveals **hidden power structures** and ensures that governance discussions are **inclusive and realistic**.

Document the Stakeholder Map for Future Reference

The stakeholder map should be **clearly documented**, capturing all roles and their positions relative to the data lifecycle. This record will serve as a **valuable reference** for future governance workshops, ensuring **continuity in understanding stakeholder involvement** and providing a foundation for ongoing improvements.

3. Next Steps

The following workshops for the VALIDATE step are:

- *2.2.3 Designing your Data Governance Roadmap: From Data Officer Mission Statement to Action*
- *2.2.4 Complementing your Data Governance Roadmap with a Legal Framework: From Mapping Legal Phases to Action*
- *2.2.5 Refining your Legal Framework for Data Governance: Deep dive into legal and contractual requirements*
- *2.3 Inventorying your LDT Project Data: Unlocking Interoperability, Listing and committing to share data among partners*
- *2.4 Identifying Levers, Obstacles and Objectives for Interoperability: From Awareness to Actionable Strategies for LDT Projects*
- *Bonus: Lego® Serious Play: A Transversal Tool to Address and Overcome Data Governance Challenges*

NB: The *Bonus: Lego® Serious Play* workshop is a workshop aimed at unwrapping bottlenecks via the usage of Legos, so it can be paired with any and all workshops in the VALIDATE step.

Next Methodology steps:

- *Done: Complete the EXPLORE workshops*
- *Ongoing: Complete the VALIDATE workshops*
- *Complete the DEFINE workshops*
- *Complete the IMPLEMENT workshops*

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